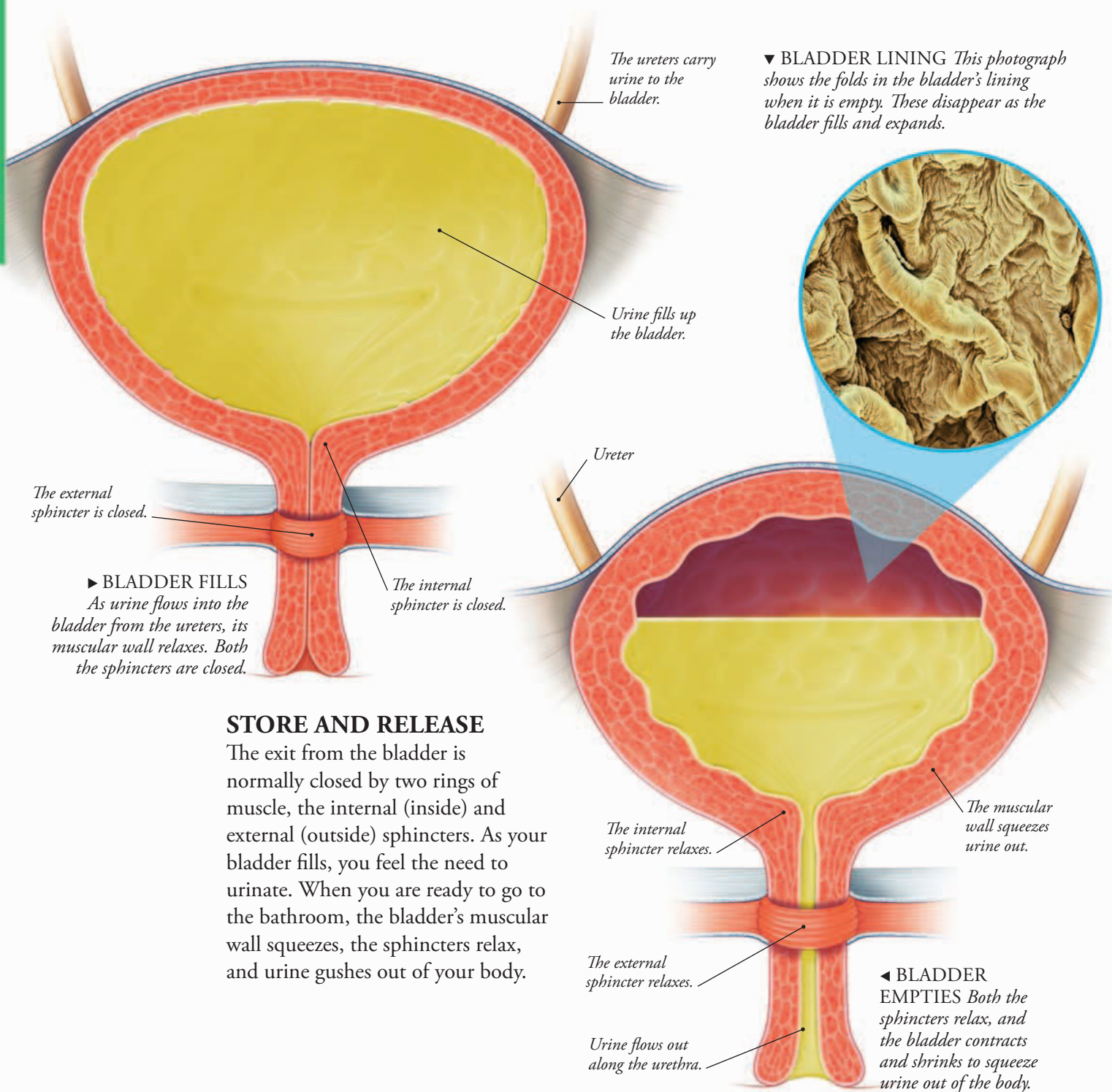


Filling and emptying

Urine is produced by the kidneys in a steady trickle, 24 hours a day. If it was released from the body in the same way, the constant dribble of urine would make life very unpleasant. Fortunately, we have a stretchy, muscular bag called the bladder, which stores urine until we feel the need to release it.



► BLADDER FILLS

As urine flows into the bladder from the ureters, its muscular wall relaxes. Both the sphincters are closed.

STORE AND RELEASE

The exit from the bladder is normally closed by two rings of muscle, the internal (inside) and external (outside) sphincters. As your bladder fills, you feel the need to urinate. When you are ready to go to the bathroom, the bladder's muscular wall squeezes, the sphincters relax, and urine gushes out of your body.